

SET YOUR ELDERS FREE

TECH TIPS AND ADVICE THAT CAN HELP ELDERS BECOME MORE INDEPENDENT THROUGH TECH

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They may not have been born unlocking touchscreen smartphone screens or taking photos of their food to post online, but our elders shouldn't be underestimated to handle the latest technology or gadget – whether it's using social media or video calling to stay in touch with peers or relatives. All our family and friends' WhatsApp groups are proof of how quickly elders can master new technologies that's relevant for them. Yes, having said that, with the constant advancement in tech platforms and devices, our elders might need a helping hand every now and then – if they aren't already keeping themselves updated through YouTube. This guide is by no means comprehensive, but it's a starting point for elders to master some basic tech tips to enhance their quality of life and become more independent as they age.

Elder friendly tips for Android Phones:

- **Large Font & Icons:** Go to Settings > Display > Font Size and Settings > Display > Display Size to increase the size of text and icons respectively.
- **Simple Launcher:** Download launchers like "Simple Launcher" or "Big Launcher" from the Google Play Store. These launchers offer a simplified interface with large icons and essential apps.



- **Voice Assistant:** Activate Google Assistant so that seniors can use voice commands for tasks like calling, setting reminders, or asking questions.
- **Magnification Gestures:** Enable magnification in Settings > Accessibility. Once activated, a quick triple-tap on the screen will zoom in.
- **Increase Touch & Hold Delay:** Adjust the touch sensitivity by going to Settings > Accessibility > Touch & hold delay. This helps prevent unintentional touches.
- **Real-time Text (RTT) Calls:** For those with hearing impairment, turn on RTT calls in Settings > Accessibility.
- **Color Adjustments:** For those with color vision deficiencies, go to Settings > Accessibility > Color correction.
- **Easy Mode (Samsung Devices):** For Samsung users, the "Easy mode" feature simplifies the home screen layout and icons.

Elder friendly tips for iPhones:

- **Larger Text:** Go to Settings > Display & Brightness > Text Size to adjust the font size. Additionally, Settings > Accessibility > Display & Text Size > Larger Text allows for even bigger font options.
- **Bold Text:** In Settings > Display & Brightness, toggle on "Bold Text" to make text easier to read.
- **Magnifier:** This built-in tool turns the iPhone into a magnifying glass. Activate it in Settings > Accessibility > Magnifier.
- **VoiceOver:** A gesture-based screen reader. Turn it on in Settings > Accessibility > VoiceOver.
- **Reduce Motion:** For elders sensitive to motion effects or transitions, go to Settings > Accessibility > Motion > Reduce Motion.
- **Siri:** Make sure Siri is activated. Seniors can use voice commands to send messages, place calls, set reminders, and more.
- **Speak Screen:** With a two-finger swipe from the top of the screen, the iPhone can read out content. Activate it in Settings > Accessibility > Spoken Content.
- **Touch Accommodations:** Adjust the way the screen responds to touches in Settings > Accessibility > Touch > Touch Accommodations.
- **Display Accommodations:** Adjust screen colors for those with color blindness by going to Settings > Accessibility > Display & Text Size > Color Filters.
- **Simplified Home Screen:** Keep only essential apps on the home screen and group the rest into folders to reduce clutter.